Pablo José Varas Enríquez

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Academic positions

2025—now **Institute for Advanced Studies in Toulouse**
Postdoctoral Research Fellow
Toulouse School of Economics, France

Education

2019—2025 **PhD (Dr. rer. nat.)**, *(cum laude)*
Human Behavioural Ecology
Max Planck Institute for Evolutionary Anthropology, Germany

2017—2019 **MSc**
Biological Sciences: Ecology and Evolution track
Universiteit van Amsterdam, The Netherlands

2008—2012 **Bachelors**, *(with distinction)*
Anthropology with major in Physical Anthropology
Universidad de Chile, Chile

Visiting academic appointments

2025—now **Guest researcher**, *Max Planck Institute for Evolutionary Anthropology*, Germany, PI: Dr. Heidi Colleran

2019—now **Guest researcher**, *Universidad Mayor*, Chile, PI: Dr. Nicolás Montalva Rivera

2016—2018 **Guest researcher**, *Aarhus Universitet*, Denmark, PI: Dr. Jens-Christian Svenning

Publications

[1] **Varas Enríquez, Pablo José**, Riana Minocher, Dieter Lukas, Heidi Colleran, and Monique Borgerhoff Mulder. "How material wealth influences age at first birth among Pimbwe women from Tanzania". In: *Evolutionary Human Sciences* (2026). DOI: https://doi.org/10.1017/ehs.2026.10069.

[2] **Varas Enríquez, Pablo José**. "Variability, resource dynamics, and the human life cycle". eng. PhD thesis. Leipzig: Universität Leipzig, 2025. URL: https://nbn-resolving.org/urn:nbn:de:bsz:15-qucosa2-969039.

[3] **Varas Enríquez, Pablo José** and Monique Borgerhoff Mulder. "Hierarchical relationship? Only development will tell". In: *Behavioral and Brain Sciences* (2025). DOI: https://doi.org/10.1017/S0140525X25100836.

[4] **Varas Enríquez, Pablo José**, Luseadra Joy McKerracher, and Nicolás Montalva Rivera. "Fertility Dynamics and Life History Tactics Vary by Socioeconomic Position in a Transitioning Cohort of Postreproductive Chilean Women". In: *Human Nature* 33.2 (2022), pp. 83–114. DOI: https://doi.org/10.1007/s12110-022-09425-z.

[5] **Varas Enríquez, Pablo José**, Silke Van Daalen, and Hal Caswell. "Individual stochasticity in the life history strategies of animals and plants". In: *PLoS One* 17.9 (2022), e0273407. DOI: https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pone.0273407.

[6] **Varas Enríquez, Pablo José**, Luseadra Joy McKerracher, and Michael G Elliot. "Pre-eclampsia and maternal–fetal conflict". In: *Evolution, medicine, and public health* 2018.1 (2018), pp. 217–218. DOI: https://doi.org/10.1093/emph/eoy029.

Under review, preprints, registered reports

[1] Nicolás Montalva, Francisca Vásquez-Estay, Margarita Reyes-Madrid, and **Varas Enríquez, Pablo José**. "Inheritance and Inequality under Communal Land Tenure: Evolutionary Convergence in Succession Regimes". In: *Research Square Preprint* (2026). *Under review*. DOI: https://doi.org/10.21203/rs.3.rs-9419290/v1.

[2] Nicolás Montalva, Francisca Vásquez-Estay, and **Varas Enríquez, Pablo José**. "Dinámicas poblacionales y comportamiento humano en América Latina y el Caribe desde la antropología evolutiva". In: *Chungara* (2026). *Under review*.

[3] **Varas Enríquez, Pablo José**, Daniel Redhead, Monique Borgerhoff Mulder, Heidi Colleran, and Dieter Lukas. "The role of resource dynamics in the distribution of life cycles within a female human population". In: *OSF* (2024). *In principle acceptance*. DOI: https://doi.org/10.17605/OSF.IO/24C7Z.

Outreach

2022 **News article**, *La Tercera, Chile*, A qué edad tienen su primer y su último hijo las chilenas?
Read the article

2022 **Cover image**, *Human Nature, Volume 33, Issue 2*
Read the volume

Fellowships, grants, and scholarships

2025 **Fellowship holder**, *Institute for Advanced Study in Toulouse*
(€ ∼ 135, 000) — Postdoctoral Research Fellowship

2025 **Grant holder**, *European Human Behaviour and Evolution Association*
(€ 1, 000) — EHBEA Workshop Grant

2019-2025 **Fellowship holder**, *Max Planck Institute for Evolutionary Anthropology*
(€ ∼ 168, 000) — Fully funded Doctoral Fellowship

2017-2019 **Scholarship holder**, *ANID—Chilean government*
(€ ∼ 67, 000) — BECAS Chile: Masters abroad

Teaching experience

2025 **Guest lecturer**, *Universidad Austral de Chile*, Chile
Course: Physical anthropology.

2023 **Guest lecturer**, *Universität Leipzig*, Germany
Course: Human behaviour, ecology, and culture.

2022 **Guest lecturer**, *Universidad Nacional Autónoma de México*, Mexico
Course: Human behavioural ecology.

2021 **Lecturer**, *Universidad de Chile*, Chile
Course: Theories of the body and health.

2015 **Undergraduate Teaching Assistant**, *Universidad de Chile*, Chile
Course: Introduction to Physical Anthropology.

2015 **Undergraduate Teaching Assistant**, *Universidad de Chile*, Chile
Course: Evolution II.

2013 **Undergraduate Teaching Assistant**, *Universidad de Chile*, Chile
Course: Human Ecology.

2012 **Undergraduate Teaching Assistant**, *Universidad de Chile*, Chile
Course: Human Ecology.

2012 **Undergraduate Teaching Assistant**, *Universidad de Chile*, Chile
Course: Introduction to Physical Anthropology.

2012 **Undergraduate Teaching Assistant**, *Universidad de Chile*, Chile
Course: Introduction to the Scientific Method.

2011 **Undergraduate Teaching Assistant**, *Universidad de Chile*, Chile
Course: Introduction to the Scientific Method.

2010 **Undergraduate Teaching Assistant**, *Universidad de Chile*, Chile
Course: Evolution I.

2010 **Undergraduate Teaching Assistant**, *Universidad de Chile*, Chile
Course: Biology.

Research experience

2025—now **Research fellow**, *Institute for Advanced Studies in Toulouse*, France
Member of the Institute for Advanced Studies in Toulouse to study the role of culture in the reproductive behaviour of humans.

2025—now **Guest researcher**, *Max Planck Institute for Evolutionary Anthropology*, Germany, PI: Dr. Heidi Colleran
Research stay at the Department of Human Behaviour, Ecology, and Culture and the Lise Meitner Research Group BirthRites to develop research projects related to the influence of fertility norms and cultural practices in the reproductive behaviour of women, among other collaborations

2019—now **Guest researcher**, *Universidad Mayor*, Chile, PI: Dr. Nicolás Montalva Rivera
Research stay at the Society and Health Research Center to develop research projects related to the relationship between socioeconomic position and the reproductive behaviour of Chilean women, the relationship of cooperative and competitive dynamics across the life cycle with human reproductive behaviour, among other collaborations

2019—2025 **Doctoral researcher**, *Max Planck Institute for Evolutionary Anthropology*, Germany, PI: Drs. Dieter Lukas, Monique Borgerhoff Mulder, Heidi Colleran
Member of the research groups Comparative Behavioural Ecology and BirthRites to study the role of variability in resources available to understand the mechanisms behind the diversity of life-history traits in human populations.

2018—2019 **MSc researcher**, *Universiteit van Amsterdam*, The Netherlands, PI: Drs. Hal Caswell, Silke van Daalen
Research stay at the Theoretical Ecology Group to study the relationship between individual stochasticity and life-history strategies of plants and animals.

2018—2019 **MSc researcher**, *Universiteit van Amsterdam*, The Netherlands, PI: Dr. Daniel Kissling
Research stay at the Macroecology and Biogeography Laboratory to study the influence of social and environmental factors in the number and variability of surviving offspring in contemporary human populations of the Global South.

2016—2018 **Guest researcher**, *Aarhus Universitet*, Denmark, PI: Dr. Jens-Christian Svenning
Research stay at the Ecoinformatics and Biodiversity Section to study the influence of social and environmental factors in the reproductive behaviour of contemporary human populations.

2015—2018 **Bachelors researcher**, *Universidad de Chile*, Chile, PI: Drs. Nicolás Montalva Rivera, Sergio Flores, Miriam Pérez
Research stay at the Department of Anthropology to study the relationship between socioeconomic position with the reproductive behaviour of Chilean women.

2014 **Research assistant**, *Universidad de Chile*, Chile, PI: PhD(c) María José Herrera Soto
Assistance in cortisol collection from hair samples and application of psychological tests for the MSc thesis: "The big five personality dimensions and chronic physiological stress in Chilean rural population with water pollution and scarcity"

2013 **Research assistant**, *Universidad de Chile*, Chile, PI: Dr. Constalza Silva
DNA collection from saliva samples and application of socioeconomic surveys for the Bachelor's thesis: "Alcohol consumption patterns and genetic variations related to alcohol tolerance in undergraduate students in Santiago, Chile"

2012 **Research assistant**, *Universidade de São Paulo*, Brazil, PI: MSc. Tamara Pardo
Dietary data collection from interviews and creation of methodological and ethics tools for the MSc thesis: "Nutritional transition in indigenous population of the Salar de Atacama, north of Chile: a biocultural approximation towards changes in the diet and nutrition in Atacama"

2012 **Research assistant**, *Universidad de Chile*, Chile, PI: Dr. Sergio Flores
Bioanthropological, health and diet data collection from human remains at the R. P. Gustavo Le Paiges Museum for the FONDECYT Project 111046: "Paleodiet evolution in populations from the north of Chile: bioanthropological and oral microbiome evidence"

Non-research experience

2016 **Assistant**, *Universidad de Chile*, Chile
Administrative assistant at the Ethics Committee for Research in the administration and ethical evaluation of research projects from the Faculty of Social Sciences, Universidad de Chile.

2016 **Assistant**, *Universidad de Chile*, Chile
Assistance in the nomination of Prof. Victoria Castro for the National Prize of History.

2016 **Biological Anthropologist**, *Proyecto El Olivar, Ruta 5*, Chile
Excavation and bioanthropological analysis of human remains in the archaeological site El Olivar, IV Region, Chile.

2010—2016 **Professional support**, *Fundación TECHO*, Chile
Assistance in the codification of different projects related to Fundación TECHO.

2010—2013 **Outreach facilitator**, *Universidad de Chile*, Chile
Outreach presentations and guided visits to highschool students, as well as other outreach projects from the Faculty of Social Sciences, Universidad de Chile.

2012 **Professional internship**, *Universidad Católica del Norte*, Chile, PI: Dr. Mark Hubbe
Management, conservation, and bioanthropological analysis at the R. P. Gustavo Le Paiges Museum.

2011 **Biological Anthropologist**, *Proyecto El Olivar, Brillamar*, Chile
Bioanthropological analysis of human remains from the archaeological siteEl Olivar, Brillamar

2011 **Conservation assistant**, *Universidad Católica del Norte*, Chile, PI: Dr. Mark Hubbe
Management and bioanthropological analysis at the R. P. Gustavo Le Paiges Museum.

Conferences

2026 **Poster**, ***Varas Enríquez, P. J.***, *Colleran, H.*, International Society for Evolutionary Medicine and Health, Kiel, Germany
Contextual effects on reproductive strategies across family, peer, and community

2026 **Poster**, ***Varas Enríquez, P. J.***, *Colleran, H.*, Cultural Evolution Society, Rabat, Morocco
The impact of cultural regimes via cohort differences on the reproductive outcomes of women from Malakula, Vanuatu

2026 **Poster**, ***Varas Enríquez, P. J.***, *Colleran, H.*, European Human Behaviour and Evolution Association, Leiden, The Netherlands
How the fertility context from family, peers, and community matter in the reproductive behaviour of women

2025 **Poster**, ***Varas Enríquez, P. J.***, *Redhead, D., Borgerhoff Mulder, M., Colleran, H., Lukas, D.*, European Human Behaviour and Evolution Association, Newcastle, United Kingdom
The role of resource dynamics in the variability of longevity and fertility among female humans

2024 **Talk**, ***Varas Enríquez, P. J.***, *Minocher, R., Lukas, D., Colleran, H., Borgerhoff Mulder, M.*, European Human Behaviour and Evolution Association, Montpellier, France
How the amount or variability of material wealth influence age at first reproduction among Pimbwe women from Tanzania

2023 **Lightning talk**, ***Varas Enríquez, P. J.***, *Minocher, R., Lukas, D., Colleran, H., Borgerhoff Mulder, M.*, European Human Behaviour and Evolution Association, London, United Kingdom
How wealth influences age at first reproduction among pimbwe women from Tanzania

2023 **Poster**, ***Varas Enríquez, P. J.***, *Redhead, D., Borgerhoff Mulder, M., Colleran, H., Lukas, D.*, Evolutionary Demography Society Annual Meeting, Paris, France
The role of resource dynamics in the variability of life cycles within a female human population

2022 **Talk**, ***Varas Enríquez, P. J.***, *Lukas, D., Martijn Egas, Montalva Rivera, N.*, Chilean Society of Biological Anthropology (SOCHIAB) Annual Meeting, San Felipe, Chile
The role of competition and cooperation on life history traits across the human life cycle

2022 **Talk**, ***Varas Enríquez, P. J.***, *Borgerhoff Mulder, M., Lukas, D., Colleran, H.*, Annual Postgraduate Population Studies Conference (PopFest), Florence, Italy
How family, peers, and community matter in the differences of fertility preferences among women from rural Poland

2022 **Talk**, ***Varas Enríquez, P. J.***, *Svenning J-C., Montalva Rivera, N., Kissling, W. D.*, Latin American Webinar of Biological Anthropology, Online
Macroecology of the number of surviving offspring in contemporary human populations from the Global South

2022 **Lightning talk**, ***Varas Enríquez, P. J.***, *Borgerhoff Mulder, M., Lukas, D., Colleran, H.*, Cultural Evolution Society Conference, Aarhus, Denmark
How family, peers, and community matter in the differences of fertility preferences among women from rural Poland

2022 **Poster**, ***Varas Enríquez, P. J.***, *Borgerhoff Mulder, M., Colleran, H., Lukas, D.*, Toulouse Economics and Biology Workshop, Toulouse, France
The role of resource dynamics in variations of the life cycle among female humans

2022 **Poster**, ***Varas Enríquez, P. J.***, *Borgerhoff Mulder, M., Colleran, H., Lukas, D.*, European Human Behaviour and Evolution Association, Leipzig, Germany
The role of resource dynamics in variations of the life cycle among female humans

2021 **Poster**, ***Varas Enríquez, P. J.***, *Borgerhoff Mulder, M., Colleran, H., Lukas, D.*, Toulouse Economics and Biology Workshop, Toulouse, France
The interplay of resource acquisition and sharing dynamics explains the diversity of female human reproductive allocative decisions

2020 **Lightning talk**, ***Varas Enríquez, P. J.***, *Svenning J-C., Montalva Rivera, N., Kissling, W. D.*, Evolutionary Demography Society Annual Meeting, Røros, Norway
Macroecology of the variability of surviving offspring in contemporary human populations from the Global South

2019 **Poster**, *van Daalen, S.,* ***Varas Enríquez, P. J.***, *Caswell, H.*, British Ecological Society Annual Meeting, Belfast, Northern Ireland
Variance matters: a comparative analysis of lifetime reproduction

2018 **Lightning talk**, ***Varas Enríquez, P. J.***, *Svenning J-C., Montalva Rivera, N., Kissling, W. D.*, Chilean Society of Biological Anthropology (SOCHIAB) Annual Meeting, Santiago, Chile
Macroecology of mean surviving offspring in contemporary human populations from the Global South

2018 **Lightning talk**, ***Varas Enríquez, P. J.***, *Svenning J-C., Montalva Rivera, N., Kissling, W. D.*, Macroecology SIG Conference of the British Ecological Society, St. Andrews, Scotland
Macroecology of lifetime reproductive success in contemporary human populations from the Global South

2016 **Talk**, ***Varas Enríquez, P. J.***, *Montalva Rivera, N., Flores Carrasco, S.*, Chilean Society of Biological Anthropology (SOCHIAB) Annual Meeting, Quillota, Chile
Socioeconomic groups and reproductive strategies: a cohort study of women from 1963-1968, Chile

2013 **Poster**, *González Zarzar T., Santana Sagrado F., Cañas Encina P., Bucchi Morales A.,* ***Varas Enríquez, P. J.***, *Maturana Fernández A., Flores Carrasco S.*, National Conference of Biological Anthropology, Buenos Aires, Argentina
Tiwanakus influence in quality of life of San Pedro de Atacamas populations

Workshops and seminars

Organised

2025 **Workshop**, *Universidad Mayor*, Santiago, Chile
Biocultural Evolution: Applications and Challenges in Human Behavior and Health

2025 **Workshop**, *Institute for Advanced Studies in Toulouse*, Toulouse, France
Sex Differences in Human Life History Evolution

Presented and attended

2026 **Workshop**, *Institute for Advanced Studies in Toulouse*, Toulouse, France
Social Influence and its Macro-Consequences — Attended

2023 **Workshop**, *University College of London*, London, United Kingdom
Researching sensitive topics in the quantitative social sciences — Attended

2022 **Workshop**, *Institute for Advanced Studies in Toulouse*, Toulouse, France
Production and Sharing — Presented

2022 **Workshop**, *Aarhus Universitet*, Aarhus, Denmark
Cultural Evolution for Good: Applications and impact of cultural evolution research and methods — Attended

2021 **Summer School**, *Toulouse School of Economics and Institute for Advanced Studies in Toulouse*, Toulouse, France
Toulouse Summer School in Quantitative Social Sciences — Attended

2021 **Workshop**, *Institute for Advanced Studies in Toulouse*, Toulouse, France
Fertility: Causes and Consequences — Presented

2020 **Workshop**, *Max Planck Institute for Evolutionary Anthropology*, Leipzig, Germany
Reproducible workflows for scientific computing — Attended

2019 **Workshop**, *Max Planck Institute for Evolutionary Anthropology*, Leipzig, Germany
Longitudinal Research Workshop — Attended

2019 **Seminar**, *Max Planck Institute for Evolutionary Anthropology*, Leipzig, Germany
Research Ethics in Evolutionary Biological Sciences — Attended

2019 **Conference**, *Universidad de Chile*, Santiago, Chile, Attendee
Conference about the current state of medical anthropology — Attended

2012 **Course**, *Servicio Médico Legal and Pan American Health Organization*, Santiago, Chile
Analysis and interpretation of samples with bone trauma and cases of violations to Human Rights and common criminal contexts — Attended

Academic services

2025—2028 **Publicity and Website Officer**, *European Human Behaviour and Evolution Association*

2026 **Reviewer**, *Frontiers in Reproductive Health*

2026—now **Member**, *Cultural Evolution Society*

2026—now **Research Team Leader: Family, Demography, and Health**, *Institute for Advanced Studies in Toulouse*

2025—2026 **Coordinator: Internal Seminar**, *Institute for Advanced Studies in Toulouse*

2024—now **Member**, *International Society for Evolutionary Medicine and Public Health*

2024—now **Reviewer**, *Human Nature*

2023 **Reviewer**, *Ecology Letters*

2022—now **Member**, *European Human Behaviour and Evolution Association*

2020 **PhD representative**, *Max Planck Institute for Evolutionary Anthropology*

2018—2019 **Member**, *British Ecological Society*

2015—now **Member**, *Evolutionary Demography Society*

2015—2016 **Treasurer**, *Chilean Society of Biological Anthropology*

2014—2019 **Member**, *Group of Evolutionary Demography Anthropology*
2012—now **Member**, *Chilean Society of Biological Anthropology*

Skills

Languages

Spanish	Native speaker	
English	Advanced	*TOELF iBT*= 103*; Academic IELTS*= 7.5
German	Conversational	
French	Conversational	

Computer skills

R	Advanced
LaTeX	Advanced
Git	Middle
Stan	Basic
Julia	Basic
ArcGIS	Basic